



Slovenian / University

Always Know Where a Room Stands

A tour of the small systems that already tell you what's true.



Why Slop University

Every door on campus already has an answer, if you know where to look. A small lamp beside a seminar-room threshold glows to say whether the room is free, and for roughly how much longer, and no one inside has to be asked. It is a modest piece of infrastructure, easy to walk past without noticing, and it is also the clearest example on hand of what Slop University spends most of its research effort doing: turning a small, informal certainty into something anyone can read at a glance, without having to ask whoever happens to be nearby.

The lamp is one instance of a much wider habit. The School of Emergent Priorities studies how a certainty like that takes hold before anyone announces it — the moment a shared plan stops being provisional and becomes the plan. The School of Continuous Improvement studies what happens once that certainty is built into something that runs on its own, and whether the thing it reports still matches the thing it was built to watch. Neither school invented the lamp, or the many objects like it scattered across a university, a street, or a share house. Both have made it their business to ask what such an object is actually telling you, and what it quietly leaves out.

This is an invitation to see that work up close.



Slop University in brief

Three things worth knowing before you read further.



Two schools, one instinct

The School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement keep arriving at the same small objects from different directions, and asking the same question of each: what does this actually tell you?



Fieldwork close to home

Our researchers study a room, a queue, a fridge, a footpath — the settings a reader recognises without ever setting foot on campus.



A growing open record

Every finding is published in full and carries a DOI anyone can look up on the University's own repository, whatever the finding turns out to be.

Our research

Where Priorities Take Hold

A priority rarely arrives with an announcement. It accumulates — in an agenda item that survives three meetings running, in a budget line nobody argues with anymore, in a phrase that keeps appearing in successive plans until removing it would look like a decision. The Trajectory Analytics Group, the School of Emergent Priorities' flagship research group, follows that accumulation from its first faint appearance through to the point it hardens into a commitment nobody remembers choosing. Its researchers sit in on the workshops, read the drafts, and track the same recommendation across a foresight exercise's whole afterlife, long after the exercise itself has been filed and forgotten. The question driving the work is a simple one: by

the time an institution calls something a priority, how much of the deciding is actually still happening?



A priority rarely announces the moment it takes hold. Most of what we study is the interval before anyone thinks to ask.

— Professor Verity Marris, Director, Trajectory Analytics Group, School of Emergent Priorities

Measurement Systems That Watch Themselves

A measurement system is easiest to trust in the years before anyone checks whether it is still measuring the right thing. The Adaptive Metrics Lab, the School of Continuous Improvement's flagship lab, specialises in the checking: it studies how an indicator is designed, how it is calibrated against the process it is meant to track, and what happens to that process once the indicator starts feeding back into the decisions made about it. Some of the Lab's most cited work follows a single dashboard figure for years past its introduction, watching the gap between what it reports and what is actually happening slowly widen, unnoticed, because the figure itself never stops looking steady. The Lab exists because a well-designed measurement system needs watching every bit as much as the thing it was built to watch.



The interesting question is never whether we're measuring. It's what we quietly stopped checking once the number looked steady.

— Associate Professor Casimir Beng, Lead, Adaptive Metrics Lab, School of Continuous Improvement

Fieldwork in the Ordinary

Not every finding starts with a dashboard. A good share of the University's research starts instead with a clipboard, a low fence, and a conversation that takes longer than expected. Researchers across both schools spend entire seasons in community gardens, strata blocks, tool libraries, and share houses, asking residents directly what a record, a scheme, or a scanner actually captures about their day — and what it never quite manages to. The fieldwork is slower than a dataset, and it catches things a dataset alone would miss: the reflexive habit, the workaround nobody mentions until asked twice, the figure that keeps its shape even as the practice underneath it changes completely.



The record and the room rarely agree, and the room is usually where the truth is.

— Dr Solveig Adeyemi, Lecturer, School of Continuous Improvement

Published this year

The pitch above draws on published work any reader can check for themselves.

- **Ticked From Memory** — a four-level taxonomy of what a car-share renter actually checks against the vehicle before a late fee starts the clock. doi:10.5555/slop.qyze4p
- **The Shed's Second Economy** — ninety-six borrowers, three tool libraries, and the swap economy a front-desk ledger never sees. doi:10.5555/slop.4z534l
- **The Sign Changed Nothing** — sixteen weeks across a pub-trivia circuit, testing whether a laminated honour sign moves a single dispute. doi:10.5555/slop.6ag6g7
- **Reading the Score, Not the Shelf** — nine distribution centres, one scanner score, and the retraining calendar it actually tracks. doi:10.5555/slop.sjdrdw

Meet the researchers

Dr Runa Adegoke, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Strategic Drift Survey, School of Emergent Priorities, convenes the School's annual instrument for measuring the distance between what the University says its priorities are and what its everyday operations actually enact.

Dr Osei Vandermeer, Research Fellow and Convenor, Review Cadence Observatory, School of Continuous Improvement, tracks the rhythm at which the School's own programs, labs, and initiatives return for review, and what happens once that rhythm drifts from what the School's own indicators would set.

Dr Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Horizon Register, School of Emergent Priorities, convenes the School's rolling account of the priorities already on approach, and studies how an entry in that register is drafted, revised, and eventually retired.

Be part of it

A university that studies how certainty forms is, inevitably, a university that has opinions about how to build it responsibly — and an unusual amount of practice doing so. Prospective students will find two schools willing to follow a small, ordinary object wherever it actually leads, rather than wherever a syllabus assumes it goes. Prospective partners will find an institution that treats a dashboard, a lamp, or a ledger as a hypothesis rather than a settled fact, and publishes what it finds either way. And anyone simply curious about what their own street, workplace, or share house is quietly telling them — correctly or otherwise — is welcome to start with the work above.

Slop University's research begins wherever something is already being watched. Visit slop.university to read the findings, meet the researchers, or follow whichever small object catches your attention first.



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